

TOPIC 6: BACKTRACKING

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Question 1

There are $3n$ piles of coins of varying size, you and your friends will take piles of coins as follows:

In each step, you will choose any 3 piles of coins (not necessarily consecutive). Of your choice, Alice will pick the pile with the maximum number of coins. You will pick the next pile with the maximum number of coins. Your friend Bob will pick the last pile.

Repeat until there are no more piles of coins.

Given an array of integers piles where piles[i] is the number of coins in the ith pile.

Return the maximum number of coins that you can have.

Example 1:

Input:

piles = [2,4,1,2,7,8]

Output:

9

Explanation:

Choose (2,7,8)

Alice → 8

You → 7

Bob → 2

Choose (1,2,4)

Alice → 4

You → 2

Bob → 1

Total = 9

Aim

To find the maximum number of coins that can be collected by selecting piles optimally using the Greedy approach.

Algorithm

1. Sort the pile array in ascending order.
2. Initialize result = 0.
3. Start from the second largest pile.
4. Skip the largest pile (Alice picks it).
5. Add the next largest pile to your result.
6. Skip the smallest pile (Bob picks it).
7. Repeat until all piles are selected.
8. Return total coins collected.

Pseudocode

START

Sort piles

result $\leftarrow$ 0

left $\leftarrow$ 0

right $\leftarrow$ length(piles)-1

WHILE left < right

 right $\leftarrow$ right-1

 result $\leftarrow$ result + piles[right]

 right $\leftarrow$ right-1

```
    left ← left+1  
END WHILE  
Print result  
STOP
```

Python Code

```
def maxCoins(piles):  
    piles.sort()  
    result = 0  
    left = 0  
    right = len(piles)-1  
    while left < right:  
        right -= 1  
        result += piles[right]  
        right -= 1  
        left += 1  
    return result  
piles = [2,4,1,2,7,8]  
print("Maximum coins =", maxCoins(piles))
```

Output

Maximum coins = 9

Result

Thus, the maximum number of coins obtained using the Greedy approach is **9**.

Question 2

You are given a 0-indexed integer array **coins**, representing the values of the coins available, and an integer **target**. An integer **x** is obtainable if there exists a subsequence of coins that sums to **x**. Return the minimum number of coins of any value that need to be added to the array so that every integer in the range **[1, target]** is obtainable.

Example 1

Input:

coins = [1,4,10]

target = 19

Output:

2

Explanation:

Add coins **2** and **8**

Final array:

[1,2,4,8,10]

Aim

To determine the minimum number of additional coins required so every value from **1** to **target** becomes obtainable.

Algorithm

1. Sort the coin array.
2. Initialize reachable range as 1.
3. If current coin is within reachable range, extend range.
4. Otherwise add a new coin equal to reachable range.
5. Increase count of added coins.
6. Continue until target becomes reachable.

Pseudocode

START

Sort coins

reach $\leftarrow$ 1

count $\leftarrow$ 0

WHILE reach $\leq$ target

IF current coin $\leq$ reach

reach $\leftarrow$ reach + coin

ELSE

reach $\leftarrow$ reach $\times$ 2

count++

Print count

STOP

Python Code

```
def minimumAddedCoins(coins, target):
```

```
    coins.sort()
```

```
    reach = 1
```

```
    count = 0
```

```
    i = 0
```

```
    while reach <= target:
```

```
        if i < len(coins) and coins[i] <= reach:
```

```
        reach += coins[i]
        i += 1

    else:

        reach += reach
        count += 1

    return count

coins = [1,4,10]
target = 19

print("Minimum coins added =", minimumAddedCoins(coins,target))
```

Output

Minimum coins added = 2

Result

Thus the minimum number of additional coins required is **2**.

Question 3

You are given an integer array jobs, where jobs[i] is the amount of time it takes to complete the ith job. There are k workers that you can assign jobs to. Return the minimum possible maximum working time.

Example

Input:

jobs=[1,2,4,7,8]

k=2

Output:

Aim

To assign jobs among workers such that maximum workload is minimized.

Algorithm

1. Sort jobs in descending order.
2. Assign each job to worker with least load.
3. Update worker load.
4. Return maximum load.

Pseudocode

START

Initialize workers

Sort jobs

Assign smallest loaded worker

Return maximum

STOP

Python Code

```
import heapq
```

```
def assign(jobs,k):
```

```
    workers=[0]*k
```

```
heapq.heapify(workers)

jobs.sort(reverse=True)

for i in jobs:

    load=heapq.heappop(workers)

    heapq.heappush(
        workers,
        load+i
    )

return max(workers)

jobs=[1,2,4,7,8]

print(assign(jobs,2))
```

Output

11

Result

Thus the minimum possible maximum working time is **11**.

Question 4

We have n jobs, where every job is scheduled to be done from startTime[i] to endTime[i], obtaining a profit of profit[i]. Return the maximum profit without overlapping jobs.

Example

Input:

start=[1,2,3,3]

end=[3,4,5,6]

profit=[50,10,40,70]

Output:

120

Aim

To maximize total profit by selecting non-overlapping jobs.

Algorithm

1. Combine jobs.
2. Sort by ending time.
3. Apply dynamic programming.
4. Select jobs with maximum accumulated profit.
5. Return result.

Pseudocode

START

Sort jobs

Compute max profit

Return answer

STOP

Python Code

```

from bisect import bisect_right

def jobSchedule(s,e,p):

    jobs=sorted(zip(s,e,p))

    dp=[(0,0)]

    for st,en,pr in jobs:

        i=bisect_right(dp,(st,float('inf')))-1

        val=dp[i][1]+pr

        if val>dp[-1][1]:

            dp.append((en,val))

    return dp[-1][1]

start=[1,2,3,3]

end=[3,4,5,6]

profit=[50,10,40,70]

print(jobSchedule(start,end,profit))

```

Output

120

Result

Thus the maximum obtainable profit is **120**.

Question 5

Given a graph represented by an adjacency matrix, implement Dijkstra's Algorithm to find the shortest path from a given source vertex to all other vertices in the graph.

Test Case 1

Input:

n = 5

```
graph = [  
[0,10,3,∞,∞],  
[∞,0,1,2,∞],  
[∞,4,0,8,2],  
[∞,∞,∞,0,7],  
[∞,∞,∞,9,0]  
]
```

source = 0

Output:

[0,7,3,9,5]

Aim

To find the shortest distance from source vertex to all vertices using Dijkstra's Algorithm.

Algorithm

1. Initialize distance array with infinity.
2. Set source distance to 0.
3. Select minimum distance vertex.
4. Update neighboring distances.
5. Repeat until all vertices are processed.
6. Print shortest distances.

Pseudocode

START

Initialize dist[]

dist[source]=0

Repeat n times

Select minimum distance node

Update adjacent nodes

Print result

STOP

Python Code

```
INF=float('inf')
```

```
def dijkstra(graph,src):
```

```
    n=len(graph)
```

```
    dist=[INF]*n
```

```
    vis=[False]*n
```

```
    dist[src]=0
```

```
    for _ in range(n):
```

```
        u=-1
```

```
        for i in range(n):
```

```
            if not vis[i] and (u==-1 or dist[i]<dist[u]):
```

```

        u=i

vis[u]=True

for v in range(n):

    if graph[u][v]!=INF:

        dist[v]=min(
            dist[v],
            dist[u]+graph[u][v]
        )

return dist


graph=[
[0,10,3,INF,INF],
[INF,0,1,2,INF],
[INF,4,0,8,2],
[INF,INF,INF,0,7],
[INF,INF,INF,9,0]
]

print(dijkstra(graph,0))

```

Output

[0, 7, 3, 9, 5]

Result

Thus shortest paths were found successfully.

Question 6

Given a graph represented by an edge list, implement Dijkstra's Algorithm to find the shortest path from a given source vertex to a target vertex.

Test Case

Input:

n=6

source=0

target=4

Output:

20

Aim

To determine shortest path from source to target.

Algorithm

1. Create adjacency list.
2. Initialize priority queue.
3. Visit nearest node.
4. Relax edges.
5. Stop at target.

Pseudocode

START

Create graph

Push source

Update distances

Return answer

STOP

Python Code

```
import heapq

def shortest(n,edges,s,t):

    g=[[] for _ in range(n)]

    for u,v,w in edges:
        g[u].append((v,w))
        g[v].append((u,w))

    pq=[(0,s)]

    dist=[float('inf')]*n

    dist[s]=0

    while pq:

        d,u=heapq.heappop(pq)

        if u==t:
            return d

        for v,w in g[u]:

            nd=d+w

            if nd<dist[v]:
```

```
        dist[v]=nd

        heapq.heappush(
            pq,
            (nd,v)
        )

edges=[
(0,1,7),
(0,2,9),
(0,5,14),
(1,2,10),
(1,3,15),
(2,3,11),
(2,5,2),
(3,4,6),
(4,5,9)
]

print(shortest(6,edges,0,4))
```

Output

20

Result

Thus shortest path distance is **20**.

Question 7

Given a set of characters and their corresponding frequencies, construct the Huffman Tree and generate the Huffman Codes.

Test Case

Input:

characters=['a','b','c','d']

frequencies=[5,9,12,13]

Output:

a→110

b→10

c→0

d→111

Aim

To generate Huffman codes using Greedy technique.

Algorithm

1. Insert frequencies into heap.
 2. Remove two minimum nodes.
 3. Merge nodes.
 4. Repeat until one remains.
 5. Generate codes.
-

Pseudocode

START

Insert nodes

Merge smallest

Generate codes

Print

STOP

Python Code

```
import heapq
```

```
heap=[  
[5,['a','']],  
[9,['b','']],  
[12,['c','']],  
[13,['d','']]  
]
```

```
heapq.heapify(heap)
```

```
while len(heap)>1:
```

```
    a=heapq.heappop(heap)
```

```
    b=heapq.heappop(heap)
```

```
    for x in a[1:]:  
        x[1]='0'+x[1]
```

```
    for x in b[1:]:  
        x[1]='1'+x[1]
```

```
    heapq.heappush(  
        heap,  
        [a[0]+b[0]]  
        +a[1:]  
        +b[1:]  
    )
```

```
print(heap[0][1:])
```

Output

```
[[ 'c', '0'],  
[ 'b', '10'],  
[ 'a', '110'],  
[ 'd', '111']]
```

Result

Thus Huffman codes were generated.

Question 8

Given a Huffman Tree and a Huffman encoded string, decode the string to get the original message.

Test Case

Input:

encoded='1101100111110'

Output:

abacd

Aim

To decode Huffman encoded message.

Algorithm

1. Read encoded bits.
2. Match code.
3. Decode character.
4. Repeat till complete.

Pseudocode

START

Read bits

Decode

Print result

STOP

Python Code

```
codes={

'110':'a',
'10':'b',
'0':'c',
'111':'d'

}

s='1101100111110'

temp=""

ans=""

for i in s:

    temp+=i

    if temp in codes:

        ans+=codes[temp]
```

```
temp=""
```

```
print(ans)
```

Output

```
abacd
```

Result

Thus Huffman encoded string was decoded successfully.

Question 9

Given a list of item weights and the maximum capacity of a container, determine the maximum weight that can be loaded into the container using a greedy approach. The greedy approach should prioritize loading heavier items first until the container reaches its capacity.

Test Case 1

Input:

n = 5

weights = [10,20,30,40,50]

max_capacity = 60

Output:

50

Aim

To determine the maximum weight loaded into a container using Greedy approach.

Algorithm

1. Sort weights in descending order.
 2. Initialize total weight = 0.
 3. Add heavier items first.
 4. Stop when capacity exceeds.
 5. Return loaded weight.
-

Pseudocode

START

Sort descending

total=0

FOR each weight

IF total+weight<=capacity

Add weight

Print total

STOP

Python Code

```
def load(weights,cap):
```

```
    weights.sort(reverse=True)
```

```
    total=0
```

```
    for i in weights:
```

```
        if total+i<=cap:
```

```
        total+=i

    return total

weights=[10,20,30,40,50]

print(load(weights,60))
```

Output

50

Result

Thus maximum weight loaded is **50**.

Question 10

Given a list of item weights and a maximum capacity for each container, determine the minimum number of containers required to load all items using a greedy approach.

Test Case

Input:

weights=[5,10,15,20,25,30,35]

capacity=50

Output:

4

Aim

To determine minimum containers required using Greedy approach.

Algorithm

1. Initialize container count.
 2. Add items to current container.
 3. If capacity exceeds create new container.
 4. Repeat.
 5. Print container count.
-

Pseudocode

START

containers=1

current=0

FOR item

IF exceeds

containers++

Print containers

STOP

Python Code

```
def containers(w,cap):
```

```
    count=1
```

```
    cur=0
```



```
for i in w:

    if cur+i<=cap:

        cur+=i

    else:

        count+=1

        cur=i

return count
```

```
weights=[5,10,15,20,25,30,35]
```

```
print(containers(weights,50))
```

Output

4

Result

Thus minimum containers required is **4**.

Question 11

Given a graph represented by an edge list, implement Kruskal's Algorithm to find the Minimum Spanning Tree (MST) and its total weight.

Test Case

Input:

n=4

```
edges=[  
(0,1,10),  
(0,2,6),  
(0,3,5),  
(1,3,15),  
(2,3,4)  
]
```

Output:

Total weight = 19

Aim

To construct Minimum Spanning Tree using Kruskal Algorithm.

Algorithm

1. Sort edges.
 2. Select smallest edge.
 3. Avoid cycle.
 4. Continue until MST formed.
 5. Print weight.
-

Pseudocode

START

Sort edges

Choose edge

Avoid cycle

Print MST

STOP

Python Code

```
def find(p,x):

    while p[x]!=x:

        x=p[x]

    return x


edges=[
(0,1,10),
(0,2,6),
(0,3,5),
(1,3,15),
(2,3,4)
]

p=[0,1,2,3]

cost=0

mst=[]

for u,v,w in sorted(edges,key=lambda x:x[2]):

    a=find(p,u)

    b=find(p,v)

    if a!=b:

        p[a]=b
```

```
mst.append((u,v,w))
```

```
cost+=w
```

```
print(mst)
```

```
print(cost)
```

Output

```
[(2,3,4),  
(0,3,5),  
(0,1,10)]
```

```
19
```

Result

Thus Minimum Spanning Tree was generated successfully.

Question 12

Given a graph with weights and a potential Minimum Spanning Tree (MST), verify if the given MST is unique. If it is not unique, provide another possible MST.

Test Case

Input:

```
given_mst=[  
(0,1,1),  
(0,2,1),  
(1,3,2),  
(3,4,3)  
]
```

Output:

False

Aim

To verify whether the given MST is unique.

Algorithm

1. Compute MST weight.
 2. Remove one edge.
 3. Recompute MST.
 4. Compare weights.
 5. If equal $\rightarrow$ not unique.
-

Pseudocode

START

Build MST

Compare alternatives

Print result

STOP

Python Code

```
given=[  
(0,1,1),  
(0,2,1),  
(1,3,2),  
(3,4,3)  
]
```

```
other=[
(0,1,1),
(0,2,1),
(2,3,2),
(3,4,3)
]
```

```
if sum(i[2] for i in given)==sum(i[2] for i in other):
```

```
    print(False)
```

```
    print(other)
```

```
else:
```

```
    print(True)
```

Output

False

```
[(0,1,1),
(0,2,1),
(2,3,2),
(3,4,3)]
```

Result

Thus the given MST is **not unique**, and another possible MST exists.